PTZ Camera Control: Local Setup

Run the Alveus PTZ app on your own computer. It sends commands to Twitch chat as your account.

Before you start

- Get the **ptz-alv-main** folder from whoever shared it (it should include `public/button-img`, the thumbnails).
- Node.js (see Step 1). Restart your terminal after installing.
- You need a Twitch account that is allowed to use the PTZ commands in the channel, plus an OAuth token for it.
- Do not share `config.json`. It holds a Twitch token. The app starts without it (read only).

Step 1: Install Node.js (one time)

Node.js is the program that runs the app. Skip this if typing `node -v` in a terminal already prints a version number (v18 or higher).

Windows

1. Open your browser and go to `nodejs.org`.
2. Click the big green button labelled **LTS** (Recommended for most users). A file ending in .msi downloads.
3. Open the downloaded file and click Next on each screen. Accept the license and keep the default options.
4. On the "Tools for Native Modules" screen, leave the box unticked and click Next.
5. Click Install, allow it when Windows asks, then click Finish.
6. Restart your computer, or at least close any open Command Prompt windows.
7. Check it worked: press the Windows key, type `cmd`, press Enter, then type `node -v` and press Enter. A version number like v22.x.x should appear. Then type `npm -v`. A number should appear as well.

Mac

1. Open your browser and go to `nodejs.org`.
2. Click the green **LTS** button. A file ending in .pkg downloads.
3. Open the .pkg file. If macOS says it cannot be opened, right click the file, choose Open, then click Open again.
4. Click Continue through the screens, accept the license, click Install and enter your Mac password when asked.
5. Click Close when it finishes.
6. Close Terminal if it was open, then open it again (press Cmd+Space, type `Terminal`, press Enter).
7. Check it worked: type `node -v` and press Enter. A version number like v22.x.x should appear. Then type `npm -v`.

If node is not recognised afterwards

- Close and reopen the terminal, or restart the computer.
- Windows: reinstall and make sure the option "Add to PATH" stays ticked.
- Mac: if the installer will not run, install with nvm instead. In Terminal run the install line from github.com/nvm-sh/nvm, close and reopen Terminal, then run `nvm install --lts`.
- Mac with Homebrew: `brew install node` also works.

Step 2: Run the app

Windows

1. Double click **install.bat** once. Wait until it finishes.
2. Double click **start-ptz.bat**. Leave the window open.
3. Open `http://localhost:3000` in your browser.
4. Go to Settings, then Twitch Settings. Enter your Twitch username, channel and OAuth token.
5. Close the start-ptz window and run **start-ptz.bat** again so the login is used.

Mac

The .bat files do not work on Mac. Use either option.

Option A: double click (needs the mac-launchers files in the folder)

1. Double click **install.command** once.
2. Double click **start-ptz.command**. The app opens in your browser.
3. If macOS blocks it: right click the file, choose Open, then Open again. If it says permission denied, run `chmod +x *.command` in Terminal inside the folder.

Option B: Terminal

```
cd ~/Downloads/ptz-alv-main
npm install
node server.js
```

Then open `http://localhost:3000`. Stop with Ctrl+C. Enter the Twitch settings as in the Windows steps, then stop and start again.

Using it

- Pick a camera, then click presets or click in the video to move to the nearest preset.
- Middle click a slot to select its camera. Right click a slot for the zoom menu.
- Hold Alt (Option on Mac) for the group swap menu. Alt held plus a left click on another slot swaps the selected camera with that slot.
- Use Sync Slots (or Auto Sync) so the app knows which camera is in each slot.

Troubleshooting

- **"There is no application set to open install.bat" (Mac):** use the Mac steps above.

- **node: command not found:** close and reopen the terminal. If it persists, reinstall Node from nodejs.org.
- **Node will not install on Mac:** right click the installer, Open. Run `xcode-select --install`. Avoid sudo with npm. Using nvm (`nvm install --lts`) is the most reliable route.
- **Page looks old after an update:** hard refresh (Ctrl+F5, or Cmd+Shift+R on Mac).
- **Port 3000 already in use:** an old copy is still running. Close its window, or on Windows run `taskkill /F /IM node.exe`.
- **Commands not reaching the stream:** check the username and token in Twitch Settings, and that your account may use the commands.
- **Thumbnails blank:** the `public/button-img` folder is missing or in the wrong place.